A light, refreshing soup with a hint of spice, this is the perfect start to a summer meal. Try adding a swirl of cream or a spoonful of low-fat plain yogurt before serving.

carrot and orange soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2 tsp extra-virgin olive oil or sunflower oil
1 leek, sliced
1lb 2oz (500g) carrots, sliced
1 potato, about 4oz (115g), chopped
½ tsp ground coriander
pinch of ground cumin
1¼ cups orange juice
2 cups vegetable or chicken stock
1 bay leaf
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 tbsp chopped cilantro, to garnish

1 Put the oil, leek, and carrots in a large saucepan and cook over low heat for 5 minutes, stirring frequently, or until the leek has softened. Add the potato, coriander, and cumin, then pour in the orange juice and stock. Add the bay leaf and stir occasionally.

2 Increase the heat, bring the soup to a boil, then lower the heat, cover, and simmer for 40 minutes, or until the vegetables are very tender.

3 Let the soup cool slightly, then transfer to a blender or food processor and process until smooth, working in batches if necessary.

4 Return to the saucepan and add a little extra stock or water if the soup is too thick. Bring back to a simmer, then transfer to heated serving bowls and sprinkle with chopped cilantro.